

RUZAWI SCHOOL

**Every Boy and Every Girl will find a
place within our world**

APPLY NOW

WHY RUZAWI

Train up a child in the way he should go, And when he is old he will not depart from it.

PROVERBS 22:6

1928

FOUNDED

6–12

YEAR OLDS

20

MAXIMUM CHILDREN PER CLASS

5km

SOUTH OF MARONDERA

A small school with a strong family spirit

Ruzawi School was established in 1928 by its joint founders, Canon Robert Grinham and Mr Maurice Carver, as a preparatory boarding school for boys. The school became fully co-educational in January 2003. Today, Ruzawi caters for children aged 6 to 12 years. In the Infants' Department, more commonly referred to as Kippers, there are two Grade One and two Grade Two classes. From Grade Three through to Grade Seven, there are two classes per grade with a maximum of 20 children in each class.

The school is situated approximately five kilometres south of Marondera. It stands in extensive grounds surrounded by many hectares of indigenous woodland and eucalyptus plantations. The David Smith Dam, located on the northern boundary of the property, contributes to the school's ideal rural setting, offering both space and opportunity for learning beyond the classroom.

In addition to fourteen classrooms, the school's facilities include a Chapel, a large school hall complete with a stage and facilities for drama performances, a well-resourced library including a reference classroom, an iMac lab, an art room, the Indigo Room for curriculum support, the Chat Room for counselling, an audio-visual classroom, a music centre with practice rooms and a school museum.

On the boarding side, the school has two dining rooms and a sanatorium. There are specialised dormitories for infants and junior girls and all boys' and girls' dormitories have recently been refurbished.

Ruzawi is a small school and, much like a family, it is sustained by a team of caring and dedicated staff who are deeply committed to the wellbeing, growth and development of every child in their care.

Find your place

From academics and sport to boarding life and the Kipper Department, Ruzawi offers children a full and rounded school experience.

EXPLORE

Academic Life

EXPLORE

Boarding Life

EXPLORE

EXPLORE

School Life

WELCOME

Welcome from the Headmaster

A message of welcome, belonging and purpose from the heart of Ruzawi School.

DISCOVER

Why Ruzawi

Explore the rural setting, family atmosphere and opportunities that make Ruzawi distinctive.

WATCH

Videos

Ruz Reflections

A glimpse at our school

Ruzawi Anthem

The School Singing our Anthem

Cover of Follow You

Our cover of Follow You by Imagine Dragons

GOVERNANCE

Leadership, stewardship and shared purpose

Ruzawi School is guided by experienced leadership and a committed Board of Governors who serve the long-term interests of the school community.

Governance at Ruzawi

HEADMASTER AND BOARD OF GOVERNORS

OUR HEADMASTER

Mr Brendon Brider

Leading Ruzawi with passion, vision, care and shared purpose.

OUR HEADMASTER

Mr Brendon Brider

Our Headmaster, Mr Brendon Brider, is a dedicated and experienced Christian educator who leads Ruzawi School with passion and vision. He holds an MSc in Educational Leadership from the University of Leicester and a BSc (Hons) in Sports Science from Manchester Metropolitan University. Brendon brings a strong academic foundation to his role, along with a genuine love of sport and of working with children.

Before joining Ruzawi, he served as Deputy Headmaster and Divisional Head at St George's College in Harare, where he was also a teacher and coach. His leadership is driven by a commitment to nurturing young minds and fostering a culture of excellence, integrity and compassion, values that align closely with Ruzawi's ethos.

Brendon is married to Phillippa and their three children are being educated at Ruzawi. He values family life deeply and believes that a strong school community is built on care, trust and shared purpose.

“A strong school community is built on care, trust and shared purpose.”

BOARD OF GOVERNORS

Serving the long-term good of Ruzawi

The Board of Governors supports the school through wise stewardship, strategic oversight and a commitment to Ruzawi's values, heritage and future development.

CHAIRMAN

Mrs M. Warren-Codrington

VICE-CHAIR

Mr W. Kambwanji

BOARD MEMBER

Mrs L. Arnold

BOARD MEMBER

Mr N. Grant

BOARD MEMBER

Mrs S. Marriot-Dodington

BOARD MEMBER

Mr J. Worsfold

BOARD MEMBER

Mr G. Smith

BOARD MEMBER

Mr P. Grinham

BOARD MEMBER

Mr S. Hosack

BOARD MEMBER

**Mrs M.
Mukonoweshuro**

CHAIR OF HUMAN CAPITAL
DEVELOPMENT COMMITTEE

Mr E. Mbofana

CHAIR OF RESOURCES
COMMITTEE

Mr D. Charters

CHAIR OF RUZAWI OLD PUPILS
ASSOCIATION

Mr M. James

CHAIR OF FINANCIAL
COMMITTEE

Mr W. Kambwanji

CHAIR OF RUZAWI PARENTS
ASSOCIATION

Mrs C. Howes

FINANCE CONTROLLER AND
PROJECTS MANAGER

Mr C. Beattie

SHARED STEWARDSHIP

Guided by care, accountability and purpose

Ruzawi's governance structure brings together educational leadership, strategic oversight and community representation to ensure that decisions are made with the wellbeing of pupils, staff and the school's future at heart.

BOARDING LIFE

A caring home where children grow together

Boarding life at Ruzawi helps children develop independence, friendship, responsibility and a strong sense of belonging.

Boarding Life at Ruzawi

DORM LIFE

Independence, friendship and a sense of home

Time spent in the dormitories plays an important role in daily life at Ruzawi and is a time when children learn valuable lessons about independence, responsibility and living alongside others.

For the boys, evenings in the dormitories are filled with both structure and fun. Before activities begin, necessary duties are completed, including the distribution of clean laundry, balcony inspections and locker and bed inspections. These routines help to instil responsibility and accountability.

Once duties are completed, the boys move into their evening activities, which vary throughout the week. Monday is Tidy-Up Night where dormitory spaces are organised and cleaned. Tuesday is Chat Night, focusing on the current Pastoral Care theme. Wednesday is Game Night, with activities such as musical statues, broken telephone and dancing. Thursday is Movie Night and Friday is Chill Night, where the boys enjoy free time and choose how they would like to relax. For boys in Grades Three to Five, a bedtime story is often read.

For the girls, the dormitories are designed to feel like a true home away from home. Bringing their own duvets from home, along with a favourite teddy, helps create cheerful and welcoming spaces. While daily chores such as tidying lockers and putting away laundry are part of dorm life, there is also plenty of time for enjoyment.

Evenings are often filled with skits, fashion shows, dressing up, storytelling and bonding time. These shared experiences support the development of the social and emotional skills needed when living in a communal environment. The dormitories are frequently where lifelong friendships begin, formed through shared experiences and mutual support during their journey at Ruzawi.

Our matrons provide the structure needed to help children thrive in dormitory life while also offering care and nurturing as children move through different developmental stages. They are available and on call whenever the children are in the dormitories and work closely with other members of staff to ensure that each child's needs are met. This includes close collaboration with the San Sister and the school Counsellor. Transition times are built into the move from Bob Williams to Gibbs, allowing girls the opportunity to spend time with the

senior matron and become familiar with the slightly different routines and expectations.

Home Away from Home

Dormitory life helps children grow in independence, responsibility and confidence.

Daily Care

Matrons, pastoral staff, the San Sister and the counsellor work together to support each child.

Healthy Routines

Meals, laundry, rest, activity and care all contribute to the rhythm of boarding life.

Belonging

Ruzawi Families, house spirit and shared experiences help children build lasting relationships.

Nourishment, care and daily routines

The Ruzawi Kitchen and Dining

At Ruzawi, mealtimes are an important part of daily life and play a key role in supporting the health, wellbeing and development of our children. The kitchen and dining team work to three core principles: balanced nutrition, quality ingredients and enjoyable meals.

Each day, pupils are provided with three carefully prepared two-course meals, along with morning cocoa and wholesome mid-morning and afternoon teas. Menus are thoughtfully planned to ensure children receive the nourishment and energy they need to engage fully in the classroom, perform well on the sports field and develop positive and healthy relationships with food.

Menus operate on a three-week cycle and are adjusted seasonally to ensure variety and freshness. Wherever possible, ingredients are sourced from trusted local suppliers and farmers, allowing meals to be both nutritious and flavoursome.

Behind the scenes, a dedicated team of chefs and waitstaff work together to deliver every meal. Under the leadership of Dylan Taylor, whose culinary experience spans both Zimbabwe and the United

Kingdom, the kitchen maintains high standards while continually evolving menus to meet the needs of growing children.

All catering is managed in-house, allowing flexibility, consistency and a personal approach. This ensures that the dining experience at Ruzawi remains an integral part of the school's warm and caring environment.

Housekeeping, Laundry & Recycling

The Housekeeping and Laundry Department at Ruzawi is made up of a dedicated team of staff who play an essential role in ensuring that the school remains a clean, safe and welcoming environment for both children and staff. The department works with a strong sense of responsibility, teamwork and pride in the care of the school.

Housekeeping staff are responsible for maintaining high standards of cleanliness throughout the campus. This includes classrooms, dormitories, bathrooms, offices and shared spaces, all of which are cleaned and sanitised daily. Particular care is taken to ensure that the dormitories feel comfortable and homely, providing children with a safe and pleasant environment in which to live.

Laundry is collected daily and clothing and linen are washed, dried, ironed and returned in an organised and timely manner. This service supports the smooth running of boarding life and helps children develop routines and responsibility around their personal belongings.

Recycling forms an important part of daily life at Ruzawi. The department oversees the sorting and collection of waste into

designated categories including paper, plastic, glass, organic waste and general refuse. Through this process, children are encouraged to understand the importance of caring for their environment and taking responsibility for the impact of their actions.

Nurturing hearts as well as minds

At Ruzawi, we believe that education is not only about developing children's minds but also about nurturing their hearts. To ensure holistic development, the school has a dedicated Pastoral Care Team that provides support, guidance and a nurturing environment for everyone.

The team includes the school counsellor, Chapel spiritual leaders, the school nurse and the Head of Curriculum Support, ensuring that all aspects of our children's wellbeing are safeguarded.

The Pastoral Care Team meets weekly to reflect on the life of the school community and to plan activities that help children grow in kindness, resilience and faith. Each school term is themed, allowing a more focused approach to exploring key values and principles.

Through Chapel services, discussions and moments of reflection, the Pastoral Care Team encourages both staff and children to explore what it means to live with integrity and purpose. These shared experiences help to strengthen relationships and reinforce the importance of care, respect and understanding within the school community.

At the heart of Pastoral Care at Ruzawi is a desire to ensure that every child feels known, supported and valued. Faith, kindness and understanding underpin daily life and remain central to what makes Ruzawi a very special school.

Belonging across the grades

The concept of Ruzawi Families was introduced in 2014 after one of our staff members attended a "Connecting Classrooms" programme at Wynberg Girls' School in the Cape. It has since evolved and taken on a uniquely Ruzawi flavour.

Family meetings take place twice a term and incorporate a range of ideas and activities. The objective for each meeting is presented to the Grade Seven pupils, who are responsible for preparing and planning the session. There are 18 families in total, nine from each house. This structure helps to nurture loyalty and house spirit, particularly during sporting events and school activities.

Each family has its own name and flag, chosen by the founding members. The flag is displayed at the start of meetings under the selected family tree and allows the children to find their group. Many families have also developed their own handshakes, adding to the sense of identity and belonging.

We felt this programme would be beneficial on several fronts. From a leadership perspective, it allows every Grade Seven pupil to take responsibility for a family unit, direct its members in a variety of activities and plan how tasks are shared, while listening to and valuing the input of younger children.

From a social perspective, the meetings encourage children across the grades to interact and form friendships with age groups they may not

normally encounter. It also allows all children to contribute their thoughts and ideas on a wide range of topics, teaching them to value others and respect different opinions.

Each family is made up of one or two children from each grade. Children are encouraged to care for, respect and cherish their family members throughout the school day. A member of staff is assigned to each family in an advisory role should the Grade Sevens need support. Towards the end of the year, the Grade Six pupils work alongside the Grade Sevens in preparation for stepping into leadership roles themselves the following year.

Health, care and reassurance

The Ruzawi Sanatorium is staffed by a qualified nurse on duty twenty-four hours a day, ensuring that the health and wellbeing of all pupils are carefully monitored at all times. The Sanatorium is supported by a nearby private hospital which provides essential backup when required. The clinic includes a twelve-bed observation ward and offers a calm and appropriate environment for rest and recovery. The school doctor visits the Sanatorium every Tuesday or as required.

Ruzawi also works closely with a local medical doctor and dentist for referral cases. Clear protocols and guidelines are in place to manage health-related matters, including illness outbreaks. The Ministry of Health and Child Care provides additional support when needed and the Sanatorium works in collaboration with the Ministry during health campaigns such as mass drug administration and vaccinations.

The Sanatorium clinic cellphone number is open to all stakeholders and parents are kept fully informed whenever a pupil needs to visit the school doctor or hospital. During sporting events, the Sanatorium receives additional support from local ambulance services to ensure that any required transfers are carried out promptly and safely.

The Sanatorium works closely with the school caterer to ensure that pupils with medically prescribed dietary requirements are fully supported. It also stocks over-the-counter medication and assists with the administration of medicine prescribed by medical professionals.

SPORTS & CLUBS

Confidence, teamwork and discovery beyond the classroom

Sport and clubs give children opportunities to participate, grow, explore new interests and build lifelong values.

Sports & Clubs at Ruzawi

SPORT AT RUZAWI

Healthy competition, confidence and character

Sport plays a central role in life at Ruzawi and is valued as an essential part of a child's holistic development. Through sport, children learn teamwork, discipline, resilience and sportsmanship while developing physical confidence and a love for healthy activity.

Sport at Ruzawi is designed to accommodate children with different sporting abilities. Our Kippers, which are the Grade One and Grade Two children, follow a fun and engaging sports programme that includes tennis, cricket, tag rugby and dance. The emphasis at this stage is enjoyment, participation and the development of basic skills.

We host a Grade One and Two Tag Rugby Tournament where children are placed into random teams, creating an atmosphere of excitement and fun. The main focus is to give children a basic understanding of the different sporting disciplines they will participate in from Grade Three and beyond.

From Grade Three to Grade Seven, children play two sporting disciplines each term. Every child at Ruzawi takes part in matches against other schools, ensuring that sport remains inclusive and that all pupils experience the excitement and challenge of competition.

Pupils selected for First Teams have the opportunity to tour South Africa annually, gaining valuable exposure and experience. A wide range of clubs is offered on Monday and Thursday afternoons, allowing children to explore additional interests. These include golf, sailing, karate, splash ball, soccer, shooting, girls' cricket and horse riding. Our golfers also enjoy an annual tour to Leopard Rock, which is a highlight of the sporting calendar.

The strength of sport at Ruzawi lies in our dedicated and passionate staff, who consistently go beyond the call of duty to ensure that competitive teams are produced at all levels. The focus remains on getting the small details right, trusting that strong results will follow.

Above all, sport at Ruzawi aims to instil lifelong values. Children are taught to win with humility, lose with grace and approach every challenge with determination and integrity. The lessons learned on the sports field often extend far beyond it and remain with pupils long after they leave Ruzawi.

Participation

Every child at Ruzawi takes part in sport and experiences the excitement of matches.

Teamwork

Sport teaches children discipline, resilience, humility and sportsmanship.

Opportunity

Pupils are exposed to a wide range of sports, tours, clubs and activities.

Belonging

Clubs help children connect across classes and year groups while discovering new interests.

A rich afternoon programme for exploration and growth

Our Afternoon Club Programme is designed to give children a rich variety of opportunities beyond the classroom. Clubs allow pupils to explore personal interests, develop new skills and enjoy learning in a relaxed and engaging environment. The programme is structured to suit different age groups, ensuring that options remain balanced and developmentally appropriate as children move through the school.

At the start of each term, pupils are introduced to the clubs on offer through short classroom presentations explaining what is available and how the system works. This is followed by a sign-up session in the hall where children meet the staff leading each club, ask questions and choose activities that spark their curiosity and enthusiasm.

Wherever possible, children are encouraged to try something new each term rather than repeating the same club, helping them discover hidden talents and broaden their interests.

Our Kippers participate in two chosen clubs each term on Tuesdays and Thursdays, with options such as Mini Explorers, Games, History Hunters and Handicraft. All Kippers also enjoy Dance on Wednesdays, which promotes movement, rhythm and confidence.

Grade 3 pupils take part in one selected club on Tuesdays, alongside Dance on Mondays and Cub Scouts on Thursdays, encouraging teamwork,

independence and outdoor learning. From Grades 4 to 7, pupils take part in four club sessions each week, choosing from a wide range of creative, cultural, academic and physical activities. For the senior grades, additional age-appropriate opportunities are included, such as Sailing.

Staff-led clubs

Many clubs are led by members of staff who generously share their own skills, talents and interests with the children. This enriches the programme and strengthens relationships, as pupils enjoy seeing staff in a different light outside traditional lessons.

Birding

Sewing

African Board Games

Sign Language

Traditional Music and Cultures

Mini Masters Art Club

Speech and Drama

Marimba

Choir

Handicraft

Language Club

Board Games

History Club

Design and Make It

Natural History

Learning Knights

Gardening

Fashion

Bible

Fishing

Chess

Boys' Tennis

Squash

Girls' Cricket

Soccer

Sailing

Paid specialist clubs

In addition, we offer a range of paid clubs delivered by experienced external providers who bring specialist coaching and professional expertise. Some paid clubs run across both afternoon sessions, while others take place during the second session on Thursdays, giving

families access to a wide range of extracurricular opportunities within the school environment.

Music

Golf

Horse Riding

Judo

Gymnastics

Karate

Clubs play an important role in a child's holistic development. They build creativity, perseverance and problem-solving skills while also giving children opportunities to connect across classes and year groups. Most importantly, clubs help children experience the joy of learning in new ways, developing confidence and a strong sense of belonging as part of the Ruzawi community.

ACADEMIC LIFE

Learning that grows the whole child

A rich, pupil-focused and enquiry-based curriculum shaped by strong foundations, individual attention and learning beyond the classroom.

Academic Life at Ruzawi

ACADEMICS AT RUZAWI

A strong foundation for curious, confident learners

Ruzawi's academic philosophy is built on a solid foundation of the Cambridge International Curriculum in the core subjects of English, Maths and Science. This is enhanced and expanded through the teaching of Shona, Art, Social Studies, ICT, Drama, Music, Bible Life Skills and a wide range of other subjects.

Our programme embraces a rich, pupil-focused and enquiry-based curriculum where the latest trends and innovations in education and international best practice are implemented. At the heart of our academic approach is a respect for all people and all things within our Anglican Christian ethos and Zimbabwean heritage.

Cambridge Foundations

English, Maths and Science form the academic foundation of learning at Ruzawi.

Individual Attention

Small class sizes allow teachers to know, guide and support each child well.

Curriculum Support

The Indigo Room provides one-to-one and small-group support for personalised learning.

Outdoor Education

Ruzawi's estate and school trips create meaningful learning beyond the classroom.

CURRICULUM SUPPORT

Supporting every child's learning journey

The Curriculum Support Department partners with the Academic Department, working closely with class teachers to ensure that children receive any required support across all areas of the curriculum. Early intervention is our primary focus and strong working relationships are maintained with specialists who provide the necessary assessments and testing.

Intervention programmes are implemented in both the Senior and Junior Indigo Room sessions. These sessions follow recognised remedial programmes and are designed to support children as they progress through the year groups. Support may take place on an individual basis or in small groups depending on the specific needs of each child.

The Curriculum Support Department is multidisciplinary, ensuring that children have the support they need to thrive in all areas of school life. Occupational Therapy sessions are offered daily and a specialist consultant visits the school once a term. A Speech Therapist comes to the school biweekly to assess children and implement therapy where required.

The department remains in regular contact with a variety of educational assessment specialists. This allows for a free flow of information, opportunities to brainstorm ideas that best support individual children and ensures that the team stays up to date with the methods and approaches available. Collaboration with teachers, parents and outside professionals remains central to the work of the department.

A happy and vibrant beginning

Our Kipper Block is, without doubt, one of the happiest and most vibrant corners of our school. Home to our Grade One and Grade Two pupils, affectionately known as Kippers, this block has been carefully designed to provide the very best foundation for our youngest learners as they begin their journey through school and boarding life.

Situated slightly away from the hustle and bustle of the main campus, the classrooms and dormitories create a nurturing and close-knit environment where children can grow in confidence. This setting allows for a flexible timetable tailored to the needs of the early years, ensuring that learning remains engaging and developmentally appropriate.

Each grade benefits from small class sizes, with a maximum of 15 children per class. This intimate setting has already made a significant difference to our pupils' academic progress and personal development, allowing every child to receive individual attention and support. Looking ahead, our vision is to expand into larger classrooms and grow to classes of up to 20 pupils, while still holding firmly to our commitment to personalised and high-quality teaching.

One of the defining features of the Kipper Block is the strong support system surrounding our children. Alongside our dedicated teachers, we are fortunate to have an on-site Occupational Therapist, a proactive Curriculum Support Department and caring dormitory matrons. Together, they ensure that every child feels secure, valued and encouraged, helping school to feel as close to home as possible.

Beyond the classroom, a broad and exciting afternoon programme runs from Monday to Thursday. Children are given the opportunity to explore a wide range of sports and activities including dance, ball skills, tennis, netball, swimming, cricket, rugby, soccer and, of course, Leap Frog. These activities introduce healthy habits, teamwork and enjoyment in a safe and age-appropriate way.

More than just a block of classrooms, the Kipper Block is a truly special place. It is a place of laughter, discovery and belonging where our youngest pupils are gently nurtured through the crucial early years of school and boarding life, laying strong foundations not only for academic success but also for a lifelong love of learning.

Broad, balanced and creative learning

Subject teaching at Ruzawi gives pupils opportunities to develop creativity, confidence, digital skill, cultural understanding and a lifelong love of learning.

Art

Creativity is a vital part of a child's education at Ruzawi, where Art lessons run from Grade One through to Grade Seven. Art is far more than drawing or painting. It is a subject that develops imagination, encourages self-expression and supports emotional growth. Through Art, children learn to think creatively, develop fine motor skills, express feelings and appreciate different perspectives.

Our pupils are encouraged to experiment with a wide range of techniques and mediums through a curriculum that covers all the elements of Art. These include line, which helps children understand movement and direction, shape and form, which explore geometry and structure, and colour, where pupils learn about harmony, contrast and symbolism. Texture is used to create tactile and visual interest, space allows pupils to explore perspective and composition, and value encourages experimentation with light and shadow.

By engaging with different forms of Art and studying the work of influential artists from a variety of cultures and time periods, children

broaden their understanding of how Art reflects society and the human experience. This exposure helps them develop appreciation, empathy and curiosity.

Art lessons at Ruzawi are designed not only to teach practical skills but also to inspire confidence, creativity and a lifelong appreciation for the visual arts.

Music

The Music Department is a space where every child at Ruzawi is encouraged to discover the joy of musical expression. It offers pupils an opportunity to step away from the busyness of academic life and immerse themselves in creativity through music, movement and performance.

Our music curriculum encompasses a variety of elements including class music lessons, individual instrumental tuition and opportunities to participate in bands and group ensembles. Children may choose any instrument and those who have developed sufficient skills through class music or individual lessons are encouraged to showcase their abilities through ensemble and group work.

Music at Ruzawi plays an important role in building confidence, discipline and collaboration. Whether performing together, learning a new instrument or exploring rhythm and movement, pupils are supported in developing both their musical ability and their appreciation of music as a lifelong skill and source of enjoyment.

ICT

Ruzawi School offers a dedicated ICT room equipped with 25 Mini-Mac computers, a set of 20 portable iPads and a high-quality printer, providing pupils with a modern and engaging learning environment. Each class is allocated a structured one-hour ICT lesson each week, during which pupils develop a wide range of digital skills.

The ICT curriculum includes touch typing, word processing, presentations, coding, robotics and digital citizenship. Pupils are taught how to use technology responsibly and confidently, with a strong emphasis on online safety and appropriate digital behaviour.

While the school primarily operates within the iOS system, pupils are also given exposure to Microsoft Office and Google Workspace platforms. This ensures that they develop adaptable and practical digital skills that can be applied across different systems and settings.

Wherever possible, ICT is integrated with classroom learning so that pupils can apply their skills in meaningful and relevant contexts. This cross-curricular approach reinforces learning and helps pupils see technology as a valuable tool for research, creativity and communication.

Shona

Learning the language ChiShona is such fun. In the classroom and outside, we embrace cultural diversity by learning about each other's

cultural backgrounds, helping to create a stronger sense of community for our children at Ruzawi and beyond.

We engage and motivate our children through adaptive, game-based learning platforms that promote critical thinking, co-ordination and numeracy, among other important skills. All of this is achieved through songs and traditional games such as dudumuduri, tsoro, nhodo, pada and ngano, or storytelling, as well as through skits performed in Shona.

Our approach encourages active participation and enjoyment while building confidence and cultural understanding. The children take great pride in learning the language and traditions and their enthusiasm is evident both in the classroom and during outdoor activities.

Vakomana nevasikana vanofarira kutamba tsoro.

A calm and cosy haven for reading

The Ruzawi Library is designed to be a calm and cosy haven that nurtures a love of reading. With the most comfortable couches on campus and inviting beanbags to sprawl out on, it is the perfect space for children to lose themselves in the pages of a good book. A surprising favourite among readers is flipping through old school magazines, where spotting familiar faces from years gone by is always a hit.

From Grade Three upwards, each class has a dedicated 30-minute library slot built into their timetable. During this time, pupils exchange their books and enjoy some “library therapy”, using the remaining minutes to settle down quietly and read.

Library Monitors help to run the space during rest time, assisting readers with book renewals and ensuring that everyone is well stocked with reading material. This allows children to head into the busy afternoon of sport feeling relaxed, prepared and eager to read.

SCHOOL LIFE

Faith, service, leadership and character

School life at Ruzawi helps children grow in confidence, compassion, responsibility and purpose.

School Life at Ruzawi

CHAPEL

At the heart of life at Ruzawi

The Chapel lies at the heart of life at Ruzawi and plays a central role in nurturing the spiritual wellbeing of our school community. Rooted in the Anglican tradition, Chapel provides a space for reflection, worship and the teaching of Christian values that guide daily life at the school.

Children attend Chapel regularly and services are designed to be meaningful, inclusive and age appropriate. Through prayer, scripture, hymns and thoughtful messages, pupils are encouraged to reflect on their actions, consider their relationships with others and grow in faith and character.

Chapel services also provide an opportunity to celebrate achievements, mark important moments in the school calendar and come together as a community.

Faith & Reflection

Chapel provides space for worship, reflection and the teaching of Christian values.

Service & Compassion

Charity work helps pupils learn generosity, kindness and responsibility.

Leadership

Grade Seven pupils are encouraged to lead through service, responsibility and example.

Growth Beyond Classrooms

Outdoor Education, Life Skills and the World Peace Game support holistic development.

Teaching service, generosity and compassion

At Ruzawi we believe that raising children well includes teaching them to look beyond themselves. Service, generosity and compassion are values woven into school life and our pupils are encouraged to give with purpose, not just because it is expected, but because it matters.

Throughout the year the school community supports a number of charities and causes that are close to our hearts.

KidzCan

KidzCan supports children with cancer and their families. This is our largest charity at Ruzawi and it is one that the children take real ownership of. Pupils raise money through their own initiatives, often coming up with creative ways to build awareness and encourage others to support the cause.

An award is presented to the child who has put in the most effort to raise funds and awareness for KidzCan. This is always a meaningful moment, celebrating compassion, initiative and perseverance.

Island Hospice

Island Hospice is a palliative care organisation that supports people who are seriously ill and helps families through their loved one's illness and the loss that follows. Ruzawi supports the Marondera branch and runs events across the year to raise money for their important work.

It is a cause that reminds all of us of the value of care, dignity and community during life's most difficult seasons.

Borradaile Trust

The Borradaile Trust is our local old age home in Marondera. Ruzawi supports the Trust in a number of practical ways. We collect goodies for Christmas hampers and invite residents to come and enjoy our plays and music concerts.

As part of the Learning Knights Award, our Grade Seven pupils visit the Trust for community service and help wherever they can. These visits are often deeply meaningful, teaching respect, kindness and the importance of giving time, not only resources.

Centre for Total Transformation

The Centre for Total Transformation, or CTT, is an orphanage in Harare that supports children through their schooling. Towards the end of the year, Ruzawi collects clothing, stationery and furniture which are delivered to CTT.

Pupils taking part in the Learning Knights Award help to deliver these donations at the end of the year, reinforcing the value of service and the impact of practical support.

SPCA

The SPCA supports animals who cannot speak for themselves. Ruzawi has fundraised for the SPCA to help them establish a branch in Marondera.

Although we do not raise money for them every year, they remain close to our hearts and we get involved in anything we can to support the Marondera branch.

We are grateful to our pupils, parents and staff for supporting these causes with such generosity. These moments of giving help to shape children who grow into thoughtful, responsible and compassionate young people.

Leadership through responsibility and service

During their Grade Seven year, all pupils at Ruzawi are expected to fulfil a leadership role. Each child is given responsibilities that contribute to the smooth and effective running of daily school life. These duties include ringing the bell, overseeing tables during mealtimes, lighting candles in the Chapel and collecting lost property at the end of the day.

Through these responsibilities, it quickly becomes clear which children understand the importance of reliability, initiative and efficiency.

To extend leadership further, a trial period takes place in which all Grade Seven pupils are exposed to the duties of the Senior Monitors who serve during the second and third terms. These pupils assist in key areas of the school such as the Chapel, Dining Room, Hall and dormitories and support standards of manners, dress, punctuality and organisation.

During this period, children are given the opportunity to demonstrate their ability to manage time effectively and take on additional responsibility.

Leadership also plays an important role on the sports field. In their final year, Grade Seven pupils are given opportunities to serve as team captains and leaders within their sporting codes. Their progress is closely observed and pupils are encouraged to reflect on their experiences and growth.

Senior Monitors are selected during the Second Term after all members of staff have had the opportunity to share their views. Once appointed, monitors

are allocated classes to support and specific roles to fulfil. Each receives a leadership file containing relevant information and attends weekly meetings with the Deputy Head and senior staff to discuss responsibilities and experiences.

Leadership at Ruzawi is modelled on the example of Jesus Christ and is underpinned by values such as honesty, integrity, service, responsibility, initiative, industry and sensitivity to others.

In recent years, leadership opportunities have been broadened to include a wider range of pupils. The introduction of Chapel, Music, IT, Sports, Science, Art and Library Monitors has allowed children to lead in areas that suit their individual strengths.

Pupils not selected for these roles serve as Rotating Monitors, spending two weeks on duty followed by two weeks off. This system ensures that responsibility is shared and balanced.

The introduction of Ruzawi Families has created further leadership opportunities, with every Grade Seven pupil given the chance to lead a Family group for the year.

We recognise the importance of teaching leadership from a young age. As Proverbs 22 verse 6 reminds us, "Train a child in the way he should go and when he is old he will not turn from it." Leadership structures at Ruzawi are continually reviewed and strengthened with the aim of developing confident, responsible and compassionate young people.

Growth, service and personal progress

The Learning Knights Award is a culminating programme designed for our Grade Seven pupils and reflects the values and ethos at the heart of Ruzawi. The award encourages pupils to develop leadership, responsibility, service and personal organisation as they prepare to move on to senior school.

Through the Learning Knights Award, children are challenged to step beyond their comfort zones and take ownership of their growth. Pupils work towards a range of requirements that promote independence, commitment and perseverance.

These include setting personal goals, contributing meaningfully to the school community and demonstrating consistent effort across academic, sporting and cultural areas.

The award places strong emphasis on service and character development. Pupils are encouraged to reflect on their actions and decisions and to recognise the impact they have on others. This process helps them develop a deeper understanding of accountability, empathy and integrity.

The Learning Knights Award is not about competition but about personal progress. Each child's journey is unique and success is measured by growth, effort and attitude. The programme provides a fitting conclusion to a pupil's time at Ruzawi, equipping them with confidence, values and life skills that will serve them well beyond their primary school years.

OUTDOOR EDUCATION

Learning from the natural world

Blessed with a beautiful estate, Ruzawi is in a unique position to offer Outdoor Education to its pupils. With abundant bird life, many indigenous tree species and the varied ecosystems provided by the dam, the opportunities for learning are extensive. Outdoor Education also plays an important role in supplementing and supporting lessons taught in the classroom.

The emphasis of the programme is not on children being able to identify every bird, tree or living creature that calls Ruzawi home, but rather on creating an

awareness and appreciation of the natural world. This awareness often sparks curiosity and leads to a deeper interest in nature, which in turn fosters a desire to care for and protect the environment both at school and at home.

Through Outdoor Education, children begin to understand that they can have a positive impact on their surroundings. In many cases, they take this learning beyond the school gates, encouraging greater awareness and responsibility among adults and parents. They may even teach others that littering is simply not acceptable.

The children's excitement and enthusiasm for being outdoors is often enough to demonstrate the value of this programme. Outdoor Education is an important part of the Ruzawi curriculum and one that we continue to nurture and develop.

Conversation, guidance and emotional wellbeing

RuzChats

RuzChats are held twice a term and offer parents the opportunity to engage with a range of relevant topics. Guest speakers are invited to share practical advice, professional insight and lived experience, creating a supportive space for discussion and reflection. These sessions strengthen the partnership between home and school and reinforce the shared responsibility of raising confident, resilient children.

Life Skills

Life Skills lessons form part of the curriculum for senior pupils and focus on equipping children with the tools they need to navigate relationships, responsibility and personal challenges. Topics are carefully selected to be age appropriate and relevant, encouraging open conversation and self-awareness while reinforcing the values taught at Ruzawi.

The Chat Room

The Chat Room provides a safe and welcoming space where children can speak openly and confidentially with the school counsellor. It plays an important role in supporting pupils through emotional, social and personal challenges. Whether children need a listening ear, guidance or reassurance, the Chat Room offers a calm environment where they feel heard, supported and understood.

Together, RuzChats, Life Skills and the Chat Room form a vital part of Ruzawi's holistic approach to education, ensuring that care, communication and emotional wellbeing remain central to school life.

A powerful lesson in leadership and global responsibility

The World Peace Game is a unique and immersive learning experience offered to our Grade Seven pupils. It is designed to challenge children to think critically, collaborate effectively and develop empathy as they navigate complex global scenarios.

During the game, pupils are assigned roles as leaders of countries, international organisations and global institutions. They are tasked with resolving a series of interconnected crises that span political, economic, environmental and humanitarian issues.

The game requires constant negotiation, compromise and strategic thinking, encouraging children to consider the wider consequences of their decisions.

As the game unfolds, pupils learn that leadership involves listening, understanding different perspectives and making choices that benefit the greater good. They are encouraged to manage conflict peacefully, communicate clearly and work together under pressure.

The World Peace Game provides a powerful platform for developing confidence, resilience and problem-solving skills. It allows pupils to experience the complexities of leadership and global responsibility in a safe and supportive environment. For many children, it is one of the most memorable and transformative experiences of their time at Ruzawi.

CONTACT US

Get in touch with Ruzawi School

Please complete the form below and we will direct your enquiry to the relevant department.

Ruzawi School, Marondera, Zimbabwe

ADMISSIONS, ENQUIRIES AND GENERAL CONTACT

CONTACT DETAILS

We would love to hear from you



EMAIL

admin@ruzawi.com



REGISTRAR

registrar@ruzawi.com



LOCATION

Marondera, Zimbabwe

FOLLOW RUZAWI



SEND A MESSAGE

Contact Form

FIRST NAME *

LAST NAME *

EMAIL *

PHONE

SUBJECT *

Select an enquiry type 

MESSAGE *

SEND MESSAGE

WELCOME

Welcome from the Headmaster

A values-driven message from the heart of Ruzawi School.

Built on the Rock of Faith in Christ

RUZAWI SCHOOL

HEADMASTER

Ruzawi School

Every boy and every girl is given the opportunity to flourish.

WELCOME FROM THE HEADMASTER

We never stop learning

As Headmaster of Ruzawi School, I believe that we never stop learning. As educators, we must continually strive to take ourselves and our pupils to places we have not yet been. As captured in our school anthem, "Built on the Rock of Faith in Christ," we strive to ensure that all we do at Ruzawi is grounded in this foundation and guided by our core values. This values-based approach enables our school community to grow on a strong and positive footing, where every boy and girl is given the opportunity to flourish. We aim to equip each child with a moral compass that will serve them well beyond their years at Ruzawi.

Leading Ruzawi with this as part of our mission allows me to take a values-driven approach to leadership, with a deep commitment to developing the whole child. I believe strongly in balancing academic excellence with character formation and I am passionate about creating an environment where every pupil is known, supported and encouraged to grow in confidence and independence.

We honour our rich heritage while embracing innovation in teaching and learning. The strength of our community is central to all we do and by fostering meaningful partnerships between staff, pupils and parents we sustain a nurturing boarding environment that is both structured and homely.

My wife and I are privileged to have our own children grow up as part of the Ruzawi community and as pupils at the school. I am immensely proud to serve as Headmaster of Ruzawi School.

“Every boy and girl is given the opportunity to flourish.”

WHY RUZAWI

A place where every child can belong, grow and thrive

A family-centred school built on faith, character, care and the development of the whole child.

“There is a special feeling when you enter Ruzawi”

SOMETHING FAR BEYOND WHAT YOU SEE ON AN OPEN DAY

RUZAWI SCHOOL

A true family community

Faith, care, opportunity and belonging are woven into daily life.

REASON 1

A Strong Family Ethos

Built on faith in Christ, Ruzawi is a true family community where staff, pupils and parents work together. Children are celebrated for their individuality and supported within a culture of honesty, humility, teamwork, sportsmanship and care.

REASON 2

Holistic Education

Ruzawi believes education is about far more than academics. Children are guided in developing grit, perseverance, responsibility, emotional awareness, friendships and leadership, so that they leave school not only well taught, but well prepared for life.

REASON 3

A Place to Thrive

Whether in the classroom, on the sports field, in the boarding houses or through special traditions and opportunities, children thrive at Ruzawi. Even sensitive children grow in confidence, independence and joy, supported by a caring pastoral structure and a rich range of experiences.

THE RUZAWI FEELING

More than a school, a place of belonging

Ruzawi's strength lies in the way children are known, supported and encouraged. From the classroom to the boarding houses, from Chapel to sport and outdoor learning, each child is given space to discover who they are and what they can become.

APPLY NOW

TRADITION AT RUZAWI

Honouring the traditions that shape who we are

From the earliest days of Ruzawi, tradition has helped pupils understand pride, respect, honour and belonging.

Founded on 3 February 1928

FLAG UP AND FLAG DOWN

A LIVING TRADITION

Flag Up and Flag Down

A ceremony of respect, stillness, pride and belonging.

TRADITION AT RUZAWI

Traditions with meaning and purpose

Ruzawi School was founded on 3 February 1928 and from the very beginning tradition has played an important role in shaping the school we know today. Some traditions may seem unnecessary at first glance, yet each one holds meaning and purpose. The daily Flag Ceremony is one such tradition.

It can seem pointless to stand still, be inspected by the Headmaster, currently Mr Brider, and then watch a flag being raised or lowered before carrying on with the day. However, flags have great significance throughout the world and it is important that our children learn how to honour and respect them.

Each day Mr Chimwayange raises the Zimbabwe Flag on Flag Lawn. Almost as important to us is our Ruzawi Flag, which is raised on a Monday and lowered on a Friday. In earlier years, when Ruzawi was a full boarding school, this ceremony took place on Sundays.

The three pupils chosen to march to the flagpole are known as the Colour Party. Another name for a flag is "Colours" and it is a great honour to carry the carefully folded flag, attach it to the halyard and raise it to fly from the top of the pole.

At this wonderful school of ours, the ceremony of Flag Up and Flag Down started right at the beginning of Ruzawi in 1928. Early photographs show groups of boys digging a large hole and others pushing a flagpole into place. From those earliest days, pupils stood exactly as they do now, dressed smartly in Number Ones, shoes polished and proud to be at Ruzawi.

The school would stand around the perimeter of Flag Lawn, first at ease, absolutely still with no fidgeting or talking, waiting for the important moment when the Headmaster, then Canon Grinham and now Mr Brider, inspected each pupil. They would then stand to attention, again perfectly still, arms by their sides and feet together, as the Colour Party marched forward and raised the Ruzawi Flag while the school watched it flutter in the breeze.

Founded in 1928

Ruzawi School was founded on 3 February 1928, and many traditions still connect today's pupils with the earliest days of the school.

Flag Ceremony

Flag Up and Flag Down teach pupils respect, honour, stillness, pride and responsibility.

The Colour Party

The pupils chosen to carry and raise the flag are entrusted with an important and meaningful school duty.

PRIDE AND BELONGING

Standing still, standing proud

The Flag Ceremony is more than a daily routine. It is a moment of shared identity, discipline and respect, linking present pupils with generations of Ruzawians who have stood on Flag Lawn before them.

RUZAWI MAGAZINES

Stories, memories and moments from school life

Browse Ruzawi magazines and look back at the people, events, achievements and traditions that shape life at the school.

Ruzawi School Magazines

[VIEW OR DOWNLOAD AVAILABLE PDFS](#)

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Magazine Library

Each magazine opens as a PDF in a new tab. You can also download a copy directly from the card.

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PROJECTS & VENTURE CAPITAL

Planning responsibly for Ruzawi's future

Thoughtful, sustainable and purposeful development that supports pupils, staff and future generations.

Ruzawi Projects & Venture Capital

VISION 2020 AND BEYOND

Progress and tradition working hand in hand

Ruzawi's development is guided by a long-term vision that ensures the school continues to grow in a thoughtful, sustainable and purposeful manner. The Projects and Venture Capital portfolio exists to support this vision by identifying, planning and managing capital developments that enhance the learning environment and overall experience for pupils and staff.

Over the years, Ruzawi has invested in a number of significant infrastructure projects aimed at improving facilities while preserving the character and heritage of the school. These projects are carefully considered and aligned with the school's ethos, ensuring that progress and tradition work hand in hand.

Capital development at Ruzawi is supported through a combination of careful financial planning, fundraising initiatives and the generosity of donors and old pupils. All projects are overseen with a strong emphasis on accountability, transparency and long-term benefit to the school community.

The Projects and Venture Capital programme ensures that Ruzawi remains well equipped to meet the needs of current pupils while planning responsibly for future generations. Through this work, the school continues to provide an

environment that supports academic excellence, pastoral care and the holistic development of every child.

281 ha

GUM PLANTATION

5MW

SOLAR PARK PROJECT

93 ha

EDUCATION MATTERS LAND SALE

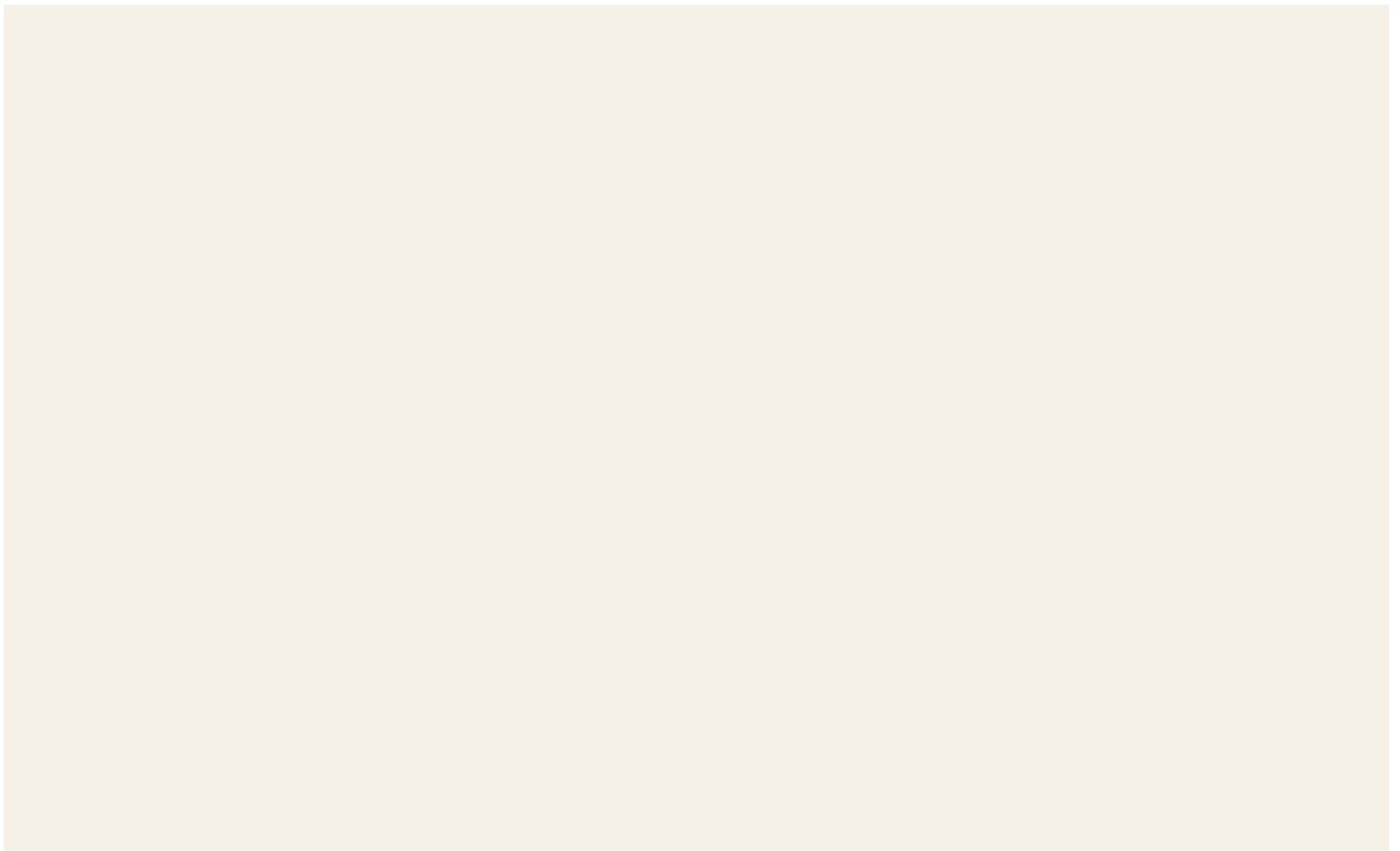
35

ECO-ESTATE HOUSING UNITS

Making full and careful use of the Ruzawi Estate

Ruzawi's "Vision 2020 and Beyond" included consideration of a variety of projects and additional income streams in order to better utilise the school's land holdings, both the agricultural and institutional zoned properties, and to supplement efforts in raising money through benefactor funding for the school's future development.

With the above in mind, the Board of Governors approved and fully supported the possibility of the following projects on the Ruzawi Estate.



Projects under consideration and development

PROJECT 1

Gum plantation

281 HA

This is an existing project that has been very successfully managed by Curverid over the last 10 years. The lease was renegotiated in 2023 for another 10 years to ensure that the project continues to bring full value to both parties.

PROJECT 2

Cattle project

RUZAWI HERD

This project is well underway and the "Ruzawi herd" has settled well into a fenced area on the Ruzawi estate, utilising all the grazing areas of the

property. Ruzawi is working closely with a current parent and local farmer who has helped ensure that this project has become a reality. It will take time for the herd to grow, but there is much potential in the next few years for this to benefit the school in a wide variety of areas.

PROJECT 3

Sale of Ruzawi Estate Land

EDUCATION MATTERS, 93 HA

The sale of the land to Education Matters was finally concluded following the successful attainment of a Certificate of No Present Interest from the Zimbabwean Government. The idea is fully aligned to the principles and ethos of our founders, as Education Matters is a non-profit organisation that identifies Zimbabwean gifted children whose families do not have the financial means to educate them. They are educated for their A Level years in Zimbabwe and then the vast majority are placed into red-brick universities in the USA, with the aim of returning to Zimbabwe to give back to the community.

The funds realised from the sale have been used for infrastructural development including upgrading all public toilet facilities, Grade 1 and 2 classroom extensions including reading rooms, the Gibbs girls' dorm extension with a new wing and an extra 20 beds, complete refurbishment of

the Petty Cote Lane flats, completion of Winchester Pavilion, and partial refurbishment of the Headmaster's Lodge, which is ongoing.

PROJECT 4

Solar Park

7 HA, 5MW PROJECT

This 5MW project has completed all geotechnical and topographical studies and has now been granted all the necessary approvals, such as GIA and SPV registration. Construction is now aimed to be completed by the end of 2026, following the further granting of Prescribed Asset Status, a Government Project Support Agreement and a Reserve Bank Letter of Comfort. All that remains to be achieved in the remainder of 2025 is project financial close.

PROJECT 5

Residential eco-estate

INCLUDING STAFF RETIREMENT VILLAGE

The housing project, consisting of 35 units, aims to generate funds to build an extra 10 houses for staff, either retired or current, protect the boundary from

Marondera town encroachment, and preserve the Miombo woodland environment.

FUTURE GENERATIONS

A school estate planned with purpose

Through careful planning, strategic partnerships and responsible stewardship, Ruzawi continues to protect its heritage while developing facilities and opportunities that will benefit pupils and staff for years to come.

OPPORTUNITIES AT RUZAWI

Junior Masters and Mistresses

A unique opportunity for young adults to grow, serve and discover their strengths within a supportive school environment.

Make a meaningful impact in the lives of children

APPLY TO BE A JM

JUNIOR MASTER & MISTRESS PROGRAMME

Serve, learn and grow

A structured opportunity to gain confidence, responsibility and experience in school life.

JUNIOR MASTERS AND MISTRESSES

A chance to discover strengths and make a difference

Ruzawi offers a unique opportunity to young people who have recently left high school and are keen to experience what working life feels like within a supportive and structured environment. The Junior Master and Mistress programme allows young adults to discover interests and strengths they may not yet realise they have, whether that be coaching a sport in the afternoon or simply spending time engaging with children.

Being a Junior Master or Mistress provides countless opportunities to make a meaningful impact in the lives of the children. This may be on the sports field while playing touch rugby, in the dormitories during games such as musical statues or through shared moments like movie nights. These everyday interactions play an important role in building trust, confidence and connection.

Working in the classroom is often a highlight of the role. Junior Masters and Mistresses gain valuable insight into teaching methods and classroom management, particularly through involvement in music lessons and play rehearsals. Seeing the enjoyment and enthusiasm of the children makes the experience both rewarding and memorable.

Beyond supporting the children, the programme also supports the personal development of the Junior Masters and Mistresses themselves. The system at Ruzawi encourages young adults to learn how to balance responsibility, priorities and personal wellbeing. Along the way, they develop vital life skills that prepare them for future studies, careers and the wider world.

APPLY TO BE A JM

Junior Master or Mistress Application

Complete the form below and upload your CV. The form is ready to be connected to your chosen email, CRM or backend service.

FIRST NAME *

First

LAST NAME *

Last

EMAIL *

your@email.com

COMMENT OR MESSAGE *

Write your message here

CV *

Drag & Drop Files

Choose files to upload. You can upload up to 2 files.

CHOOSE FILES

SUBMIT APPLICATION